LESSON 9

The Surprise

From Haydn's "Surprise" Symphony: a quiet tune, played again even quieter… then a loud chord to wake everyone up.

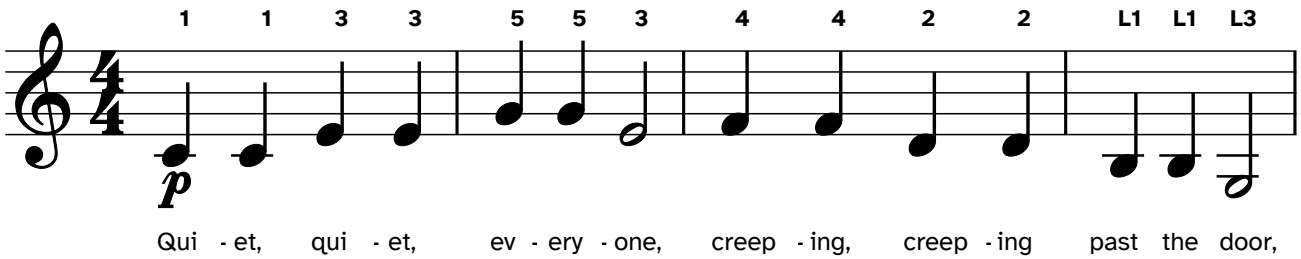
LISTEN FIRST
Scan the code: listen once, then hum along.

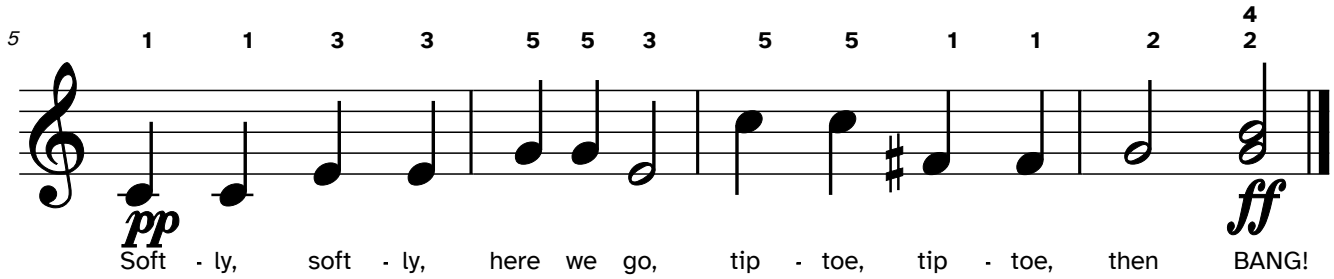
THE WOW MOMENT
The surprise: Haydn wrote it for listeners who dozed off. Play the second half as softly as a whisper… then BANG: a G chord with both hands!

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing. Sing it soft, then very soft… then BANG! Then play the tune; the left hand answers in bar 4.

Right hand: the C position; in bar 7 it moves up: thumb on F♯, 5 on the high C. **L:** the answer in bar 4, just under middle C, is the left hand's (thumb on B). Both hands meet on page 3.



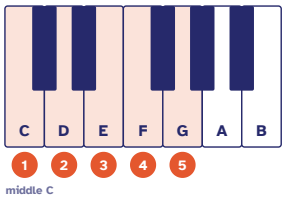


☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Played the soft and the very soft** ☐ **Made the BANG**

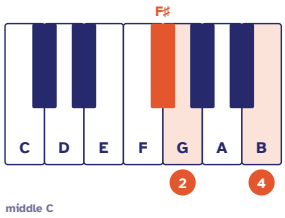
2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

RIGHT HAND · C POSITION



BAR 7 · THUMB ON F♯, 5 ON HIGH C



NEW IN THIS SONG

F♯: the black key just right of F, F's best friend. **p** soft, **pp** very soft, **ff** very loud. **Hands move:** the left hand up for its answer, the right hand up for the high C.

THE RHYTHM

Say it in time, then clap and count: clap on coral, hold on grey, lift on a rest.

THE TIME

4/4

Top 4: four beats in every bar.

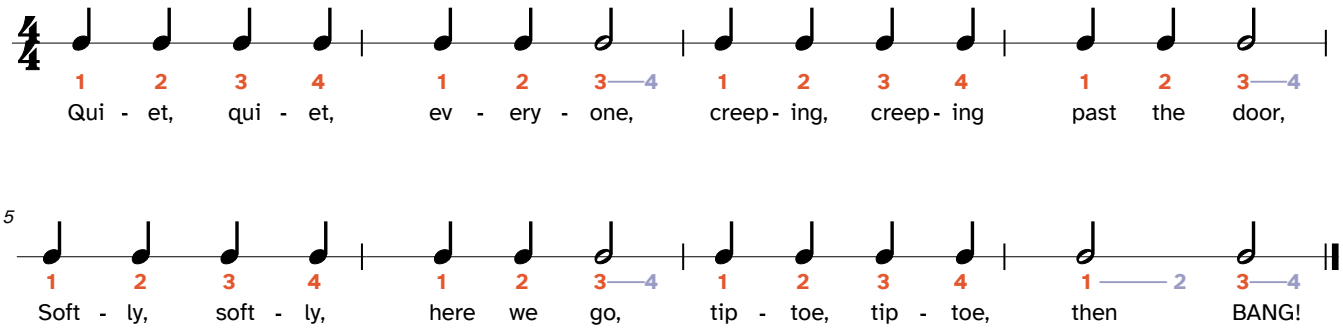
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

THE NOTES

crotchet: walk — 1 beat ●

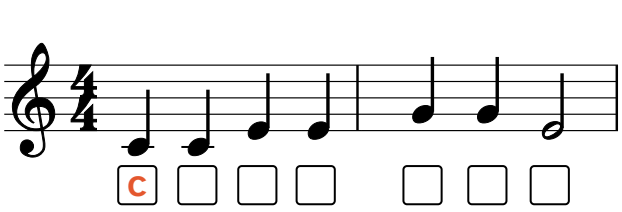
crotchet rest: knock — 1 beat ●

minim: hold — 2 beats ●●

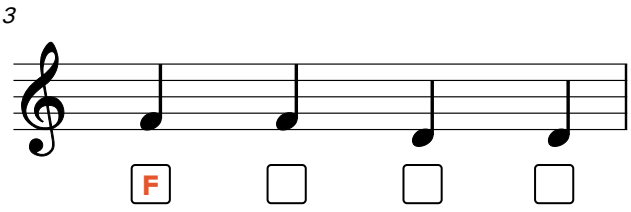


THE NOTES

Write each letter. ♯ in front: the black key just to the right. Write F♯.

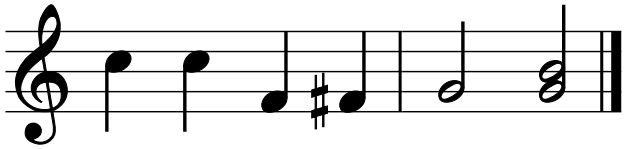


3



SPOT THE MISTAKE

One note here is wrong. Play it, then the same bars on page 1: which note sounds wrong? Circle it.



☐ Said it in time ☐ Clapped it ☐ Wrote the letters ☐ Spotted the mistake

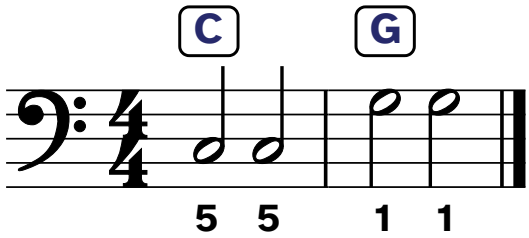
3 Lead sheet

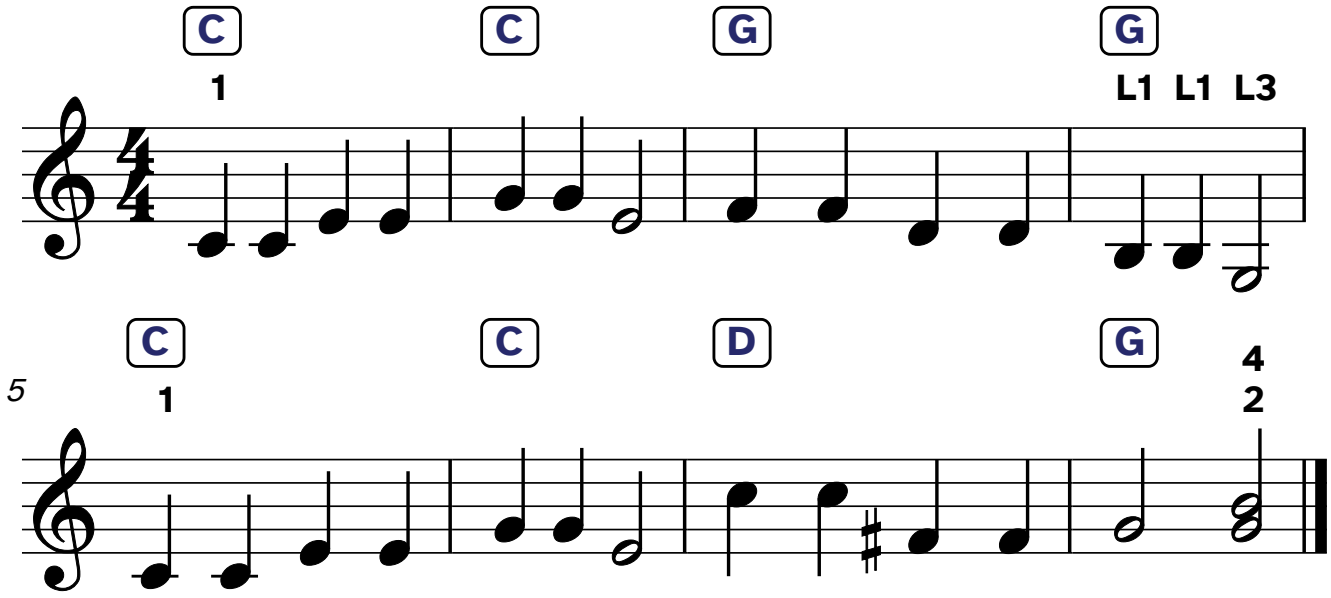
The tune and its names, C, G and D. The left hand plays pattern 3. In bars 3 and 4 it plays the answer instead (the notes marked L), and in bar 8 it joins the BANG.

PATTERN 3 · THE ROOT TWICE

The root on beats 1 and 3: two minims a bar, a slow heartbeat. D (finger 4) joins in bar 7.

C D G





1 Tune alone, right hand

2 Pattern alone, reading only the names

3 Together, slowly, then with the band

4 · CHECK

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	Slowly	Steady	With the band	Fast
The tune				
With the pattern				
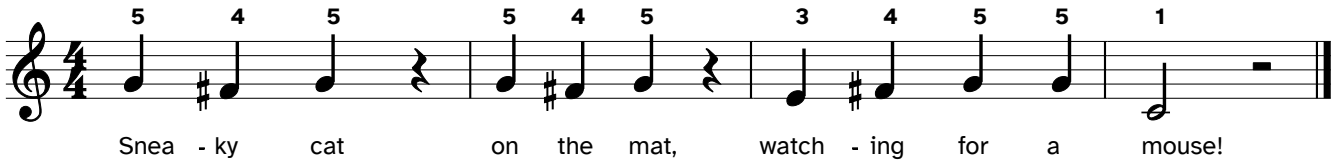
LISTEN BACK ☐ I recorded it ☐ It sounded right

+ More to play

Use what this lesson taught in new ways, then take a first look at the next lesson.

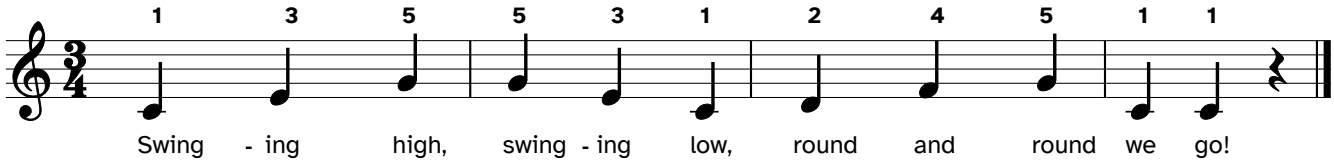
SNEAKY CAT

Tiptoe music: 4 slides onto the black key and back, like a cat creeping.



SWING SONG

A peek at Lesson 10: three beats in a bar. Lean on beat 1, like a swing.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole song that way. Record it on a phone and listen back: does it sound the way you meant?

- ☐ **The other way round: very soft first, then soft**
- ☐ **Two bangs at the end**
- ☐ **Up high: an octave higher**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the song once
2. The tune, soft and very soft
3. Pattern 3 from the names (page 3)
4. Both hands, with the band

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played Sneaky Cat** ☐ **Played Swing Song**